1. Dilution of solids of rocks on encountering water is called hydration.
2. Hydration is reversible and long, continued repetition of this process causes fatigue in the rocks and may lead to their disintegration.

Which of the statement(s) above is/are correct? Answer using codes mentioned below:

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

12. *Assertion(A):* In weathering, oxidation means a combination of a mineral with oxygen to form oxides (rusting in case of iron) or hydroxides. *Reason(R):* Red soils appear red due to the pres¬ence of iron oxides.

Mark the correct answer based on the instruc¬tions given below.

(a) If both A and R are correct and R is the cor¬rect explanation of A
(b) If A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A
(c) If only A is correct but B is wrong
(d) If both A and R are incorrect

13. Which of the following can help weathering processes?

1. Burrowing and wedging by organisms like earthworms, rodents
2. Human beings by disturbing vegetation, ploughing and cultivating soils
3. Ground water reaching surface through cap¬illary action

Answer using the codes given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

14. *Assertion(A):* Hills with smooth rounded sur¬faces are more common in Deccan Plateau rather than the Western Ghats of India.

Reason(R): Exfoliation of rock surfaces is most effective in dry climates and high elevations where diurnal temperature changes